

R' Yosef Shlomo Goldstein, the מחבר of a sefer called דברי יושר from the ישיבה in Gateshead, is quoted in the Kol HaTorah journal with the following דבר תורה on this pasuk in (8:19):

וְאַתָּנָה אֶת הַלּוֹיִם נִתְּנִים לְאַהֲרֹן וּלְבָנָיו מִתּוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲבֹד אֶת עֲבֹדַת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּאַהֲלָ מוֹעֵד וּלְכַפֵּר עַל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא יִהְיֶה בְּבָנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל נֶגֶף בְּגִשֶׁת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ

We're talking about when the לויים were being prepared to serve in the משכן and eventually in the בית - As we know, the לויים replaced the בכורים who lost their opportunity at the העגל. חטא העגל. רש"י points out an interesting fact, which is not usual for רש"י, it's more like the טורים. רש"י points out that it says the words בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל five times in this pasuk, to teach you חֵיבָתָן, that Hashem loves all of ישראל כלל:

חֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים נֶאֱמָרוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִקְרָא זֶה, לְהוֹדִיעַ חֵבְתָּן, שֶׁנִּכְפַּל אֲזַכְרוּתָהֶן בְּמִקְרָא אֶחָד כְּמִנְיֵן חֲמִשָּׁה חֲמִשִּׁי תוֹרָה, וְכָךְ רָאִיתִי בַּבְּ"ר

Hashem looks at us just like the חמישה חומשי תורה. What is the implication of that? R' Goldstein explains that it says in פרשת יתרו (שמות י"ט:ה'): וְעַתָּה אִם שָׁמוֹעַ תִּשְׁמָעוּ בְּקוֹלִי וְשִׁמְרַתֶּם אֶת בְּרִיתִי וְהָיִיתֶם לִי סֻגְלָה מִכָּל הָעַמִּים כִּי לִי (שמות י"ט:ה'): אֹצֵר חֵבִיב סְגוּלָה, חטא העגל. רש"י says on the spot over there, סגולה means an אֹצֵר חֵבִיב - a wonderful, dear treasure. Just like a סגולה which is all over תנ"ך, which means a vessel full of precious jewels and precious gems that kings put away in their treasure house., so too Hashem says to ישראל, כלל, "You are to me like a סגולה amongst all of the other nations." Why is that? The חֵיבָה that has for the הקדוש ברוך הוא comes from the חֵיבָה of the תורה. We recently had שבועות with the awesome פגישה between the הקדוש ברוך הוא and בני ישראל where we received the תורה. The fact that number one, כלל ישראל, received the תורה, and number two, equally as important if not perhaps even more so, that they're בתורה. Therefore Hashem has the words בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל five times by the לויים. Why? To show us the אהבה that has for his nation כלל ישראל.

Now, why mention it here of all places? Here we're choosing the לויים to be special members of כלל ישראל, and they're picked out to be on a higher מדרגה. They have an even more special בחירה. We're called the משרתים לפני השם. So בני ישראל might have had a little bit of a twinge there to feel that they're not on the same level in the חֵיבָה of the הקדוש ברוך הוא. Therefore, the pasuk says, each member of כלל ישראל is חֵבִיב to the הקדוש ברוך הוא. Why? In the זכות of the תורה. The pasuk says the words בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל five times to tell you that the חֵיבָה of תורה is superior to any other חֵיבָה. We know that in תלמוד תורה רמב"ם writes, quoting from פרקי אבות, that there are three מלכות: מלכות כתר, מלכות חכמה, and מלכות עולם. The מלכות of כתר is only for אהרן and his children. The מלכות of חכמה is only for דוד and his children, but the מלכות of עולם is free and available for each and every member of כלל ישראל. You see that is greater than all of them.

The pasuk teaches us that this is the basis for חֵיבָה of the הקדוש ברוך הוא for כלל ישראל. It's brought here, in this specific spot where the לויים are being chosen, because Hashem wants to show us, (and you have to know how to learn and read רש"י to look into the פסוק to show this love for כלל ישראל) that even in an area where part of כלל ישראל is chosen, Hashem says, "I love you all, and I love each and every one with חֵיבָה because of the זכות of the תורה." In that זכות may we all join in that חֵיבָה and may we all benefit from this love that Hashem has for us, both in עולם הזה and in עולם הבא. And hopefully soon when משיח comes, we will see it בחוש.

